# Application for Asylum and for Withholding of Removal

**Department of Homeland Security**
U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services

**USCIS**
**Form I-589**
OMB No. 1615-0067
Expires 09/30/2027

**START HERE - Type or print in black ink. See the instructions for information about eligibility and how to complete and file this application.**

**NOTE:** ☑ Check this box if you also want to apply for withholding of removal under the Convention Against Torture.

## Part A.I. Information About You

| **1.** Alien Registration Number(s) (A-Number) *(if any)* | **2.** U.S. Social Security Number *(if any)* | **3.** USCIS Online Account Number *(if any)* |
|---|---|---|
| N/A | N/A | N/A |

| **4.** Complete Last Name | **5.** First Name | **6.** Middle Name |
|---|---|---|
| Rivas Montero | Maria | Alejandra |

**7.** What other names have you used *(include maiden name and aliases)?*
N/A

**8.** Residence in the U.S. *(where you physically reside)*

| Street Number and Name | Apt. Number |
|---|---|
| 4210 Bellaire Boulevard, Apt 12 | 12 |

| City | State | Zip Code | Telephone Number |
|---|---|---|---|
| Houston | TX | 77025 | ( 713 ) 555-0199 |

(**NOTE:** *You must be residing in the United States to submit this form.*)

**9.** Mailing Address in the U.S. *(if different than the address in Item Number 8)*

| In Care Of *(if applicable):* | Telephone Number |
|---|---|
| N/A | ( 713 ) 555-0148 |

| Street Number and Name | Apt. Number |
|---|---|
| 4210 Bellaire Boulevard, Apt 12 | 12 |

| City | State | Zip Code |
|---|---|---|
| Houston | TX | 77025 |

**10.** Sex ☐ Male ☑ Female

**11.** Marital Status: ☐ Single ☑ Married ☐ Divorced ☐ Widowed

| **12.** Date of Birth *(mm/dd/yyyy)* | **13.** City and Country of Birth |
|---|---|
| 04/18/1991 | Maracaibo, Venezuela |

| **14.** Present Nationality *(Citizenship)* | **15.** Nationality at Birth | **16.** Race, Ethnic, or Tribal Group | **17.** Religion |
|---|---|---|---|
| Venezuelan | Venezuelan | N/A | Catholic |

**18.** *Check the box, a through c, that applies:* **a.** ☑ I have never been in Immigration Court proceedings.

**b.** ☐ I am now in Immigration Court proceedings. **c.** ☐ I am **not** now in Immigration Court proceedings, but I have been in the past.

**19.** *Complete 19 a through c.*

**a.** When did you last leave your country? *(mm/dd/yyyy)* 02/27/2026 **b.** What is your current I-94 Number, if any? N/A

**c.** List each entry into the U.S. beginning with your most recent entry. *List date (mm/dd/yyyy), place, and your status for each entry. (Attach additional sheets as needed.)*

| Date | Place | Status | Date Status Expires |
|---|---|---|---|
| 03/15/2026 | Eagle Pass, Texas | Humanitarian parole | 03/15/2028 |
| N/A | N/A | N/A | |
| N/A | N/A | N/A | |

| **20.** What country issued your last passport or travel document? | **21.** Passport Number 148392756<br>Travel Document Number N/A | **22.** Expiration Date *(mm/dd/yyyy)* |
|---|---|---|
| Venezuela | | 09/30/2029 |

| **23.** What is your native language *(include dialect, if applicable)?* | **24.** Are you fluent in English? | **25.** What other languages do you speak fluently? |
|---|---|---|
| Spanish | ☐ Yes ☑ No | N/A |

## Part A.II. Information About Your Spouse and Children

| For EOIR use only. | For USCIS use only. | Action: | Decision: |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | Interview Date, if applicable: | Approval Date: |
| | | Asylum Officer ID No.: | Denial Date: |
| | | | Referral Date: |

**Your spouse** ☐ I am not married. (Skip to **Your Children** below.)

| 1. Alien Registration Number (A-Number) *(if any)* | 2. Passport/ID Card Number *(if any)* | 3. Date of Birth *(mm/dd/yyyy)* | 4. U.S. Social Security Number *(if any)* |
|---|---|---|---|
| N/A | 152884031 | 11/02/1988 | N/A |
| **5.** Complete Last Name | **6.** First Name | **7.** Middle Name | **8.** Other names used *(include maiden name and aliases)* |
| Fernandez Soto | Carlos | Eduardo | N/A |
| **9.** Date of Marriage *(mm/dd/yyyy)* | **10.** Place of Marriage | **11.** City and Country of Birth | |
| 08/22/2013 | N/A | Maracaibo, Venezuela | |
| **12.** Nationality *(Citizenship)* | **13.** Race, Ethnic, or Tribal Group | **14.** Sex | |
| Venezuelan | N/A | ☑ Male ☐ Female | |

**15.** Is this person in the U.S.?

☐ Yes *(Complete Blocks 16 to 24.)* ☐ No *(Specify location):* N/A

| 16. Place of last entry into the U.S. | 17. Date of last entry into the U.S. *(mm/dd/yyyy)* | 18. I-94 Number *(if any)* | 19. Status when last admitted *(Visa type, if any)* |
|---|---|---|---|
| Eagle Pass, Texas | 03/15/2026 | N/A | Humanitarian parole |
| **20.** What is your spouse's current status? | **21.** What is the expiration date of his/her authorized stay, if any? *(mm/dd/yyyy)* | **22.** Is your spouse in Immigration Court proceedings? | **23.** If previously in the U.S., date of previous arrival *(mm/dd/yyyy)* |
| Humanitarian parole | 03/15/2028 | ☐ Yes ☑ No | N/A |

**24.** If in the U.S., is your spouse to be included in this application? *(Check the appropriate box.)*

☑ Yes

☐ No

**Your Children.** List **all** of your children, regardless of age, location, or marital status.

☐ I do not have any children. *(Skip to Part A.III., Information about your background.)*

☑ I have children. Total number of children: 7.

(**NOTE:** *Use Form I-589 Supplement A or attach additional sheets of paper and documentation if you have more than four children.)*

| 1. Alien Registration Number (A-Number) *(if any)* | 2. Passport/ID Card Number *(if any)* | 3. Marital Status *(Married, Single, Divorced, Widowed)* | 4. U.S. Social Security Number *(if any)* |
|---|---|---|---|
| N/A | 152884477 | Single | N/A |
| **5.** Complete Last Name | **6.** First Name | **7.** Middle Name | **8.** Date of Birth *(mm/dd/yyyy)* |
| Fernandez Rivas | Santiago | N/A | 06/09/2015 |
| **9.** City and Country of Birth | **10.** Nationality *(Citizenship)* | **11.** Race, Ethnic, or Tribal Group | **12.** Sex |
| Maracaibo, Venezuela | Venezuelan | N/A | ☑ Male ☐ Female |

**13.** Is this child in the U.S. ? ☑ Yes *(Complete Blocks 14 to 21.)* ☐ No *(Specify location)*: Houston, Texas

| 14. Place of last entry into the U.S. | 15. Date of last entry into the U.S. *(mm/dd/yyyy)* | 16. I-94 Number *(If any)* | 17. Status when last admitted *(Visa type, if any)* |
|---|---|---|---|
| Eagle Pass, Texas | 03/15/2026 | N/A | Humanitarian parole |
| **18.** What is your child's current status? | **19.** What is the expiration date of his/her authorized stay, if any? *(mm/dd/yyyy)* | **20.** Is your child in Immigration Court proceedings? | |
| Humanitarian parole | 03/15/2028 | ☐ Yes ☑ No | |

**21.** If in the U.S., is this child to be included in this application? *(Check the appropriate box.)*

☑ Yes

☐ No

## Part A.II. Information About Your Spouse and Children (continued)

| 1. Alien Registration Number (A-Number) *(if any)* | 2. Passport/ID Card Number *(if any)* | 3. Marital Status *(Married, Single, Divorced, Widowed)* | 4. U.S. Social Security Number *(if any)* |
|---|---|---|---|
| N/A | 152884478 | Single | N/A |
| **5.** Complete Last Name | **6.** First Name | **7.** Middle Name | **8.** Date of Birth *(mm/dd/yyyy)* |
| Fernandez Rivas | Valentina | N/A | 01/23/2019 |
| **9.** City and Country of Birth | **10.** Nationality *(Citizenship)* | **11.** Race, Ethnic, or Tribal Group | **12.** Sex |
| Maracaibo, Venezuela | Venezuelan | N/A | ☐ Male ☑ Female |

**13.** Is this child in the U.S. ? ☑ Yes *(Complete Blocks 14 to 21.)* ☐ No *(Specify location)*: Houston, Texas

| 14. Place of last entry into the U.S. | 15. Date of last entry into the U.S. *(mm/dd/yyyy)* | 16. I-94 Number *(If any)* | 17. Status when last admitted *(Visa type, if any)* |
|---|---|---|---|
| Eagle Pass, Texas | 03/15/2026 | N/A | Humanitarian parole |

| 18. What is your child's current status? | 19. What is the expiration date of his/her authorized stay, if any? *(mm/dd/yyyy)* | 20. Is your child in Immigration Court proceedings? |
|---|---|---|
| Humanitarian parole | 03/15/2028 | ☐ Yes ☑ No |

**21.** If in the U.S., is this child to be included in this application? *(Check the appropriate box.)*

☑ Yes

☐ No

| 1. Alien Registration Number (A-Number) *(if any)* | 2. Passport/ID Card Number *(if any)* | 3. Marital Status *(Married, Single, Divorced, Widowed)* | 4. U.S. Social Security Number *(if any)* |
|---|---|---|---|
| N/A | 152884483 | Single | N/A |
| **5.** Complete Last Name | **6.** First Name | **7.** Middle Name | **8.** Date of Birth *(mm/dd/yyyy)* |
| Fernandez Rivas | Mateo | N/A | 03/13/2013 |
| **9.** City and Country of Birth | **10.** Nationality *(Citizenship)* | **11.** Race, Ethnic, or Tribal Group | **12.** Sex |
| Maracaibo, Venezuela | Venezuelan | N/A | ☑ Male ☐ Female |

**13.** Is this child in the U.S. ? ☑ Yes *(Complete Blocks 14 to 21.)* ☐ No *(Specify location)*: Houston, Texas

| 14. Place of last entry into the U.S. | 15. Date of last entry into the U.S. *(mm/dd/yyyy)* | 16. I-94 Number *(If any)* | 17. Status when last admitted *(Visa type, if any)* |
|---|---|---|---|
| Eagle Pass, Texas | 03/15/2026 | N/A | Humanitarian parole |

| 18. What is your child's current status? | 19. What is the expiration date of his/her authorized stay, if any? *(mm/dd/yyyy)* | 20. Is your child in Immigration Court proceedings? |
|---|---|---|
| Humanitarian parole | 03/15/2028 | ☐ Yes ☑ No |

**21.** If in the U.S., is this child to be included in this application? *(Check the appropriate box.)*

☑ Yes

☐ No

| 1. Alien Registration Number (A-Number) *(if any)* | 2. Passport/ID Card Number *(if any)* | 3. Marital Status *(Married, Single, Divorced, Widowed)* | 4. U.S. Social Security Number *(if any)* |
|---|---|---|---|
| N/A | 152884484 | Single | N/A |
| **5.** Complete Last Name | **6.** First Name | **7.** Middle Name | **8.** Date of Birth *(mm/dd/yyyy)* |
| Fernandez Rivas | Lucia | N/A | 04/14/2014 |
| **9.** City and Country of Birth | **10.** Nationality *(Citizenship)* | **11.** Race, Ethnic, or Tribal Group | **12.** Sex |
| Maracaibo, Venezuela | Venezuelan | N/A | ☐ Male ☑ Female |

**13.** Is this child in the U.S. ? ☑ Yes *(Complete Blocks 14 to 21.)* ☐ No *(Specify location)*: Houston, Texas

| 14. Place of last entry into the U.S. | 15. Date of last entry into the U.S. *(mm/dd/yyyy)* | 16. I-94 Number *(If any)* | 17. Status when last admitted *(Visa type, if any)* |
|---|---|---|---|
| Eagle Pass, Texas | 03/15/2026 | N/A | Humanitarian parole |

| 18. What is your child's current status? | 19. What is the expiration date of his/her authorized stay, if any? *(mm/dd/yyyy)* | 20. Is your child in Immigration Court proceedings? |
|---|---|---|
| Humanitarian parole | 03/15/2028 | ☐ Yes ☑ No |

**21.** If in the U.S., is this child to be included in this application? *(Check the appropriate box.)*

☑ Yes

☐ No

## Part A.III. Information About Your Background

**1.** List your last address where you lived before coming to the United States. If this is not the country where you fear persecution, also list the last address in the country where you fear persecution. *(List Address, City/Town, Department, Province, or State and Country.)*
*(***NOTE:** *Use Form I-589 Supplement B, or additional sheets of paper, if necessary.)*

| Number and Street *(Provide if available)* | City/Town | Department, Province, or State | Country | Dates From *(Mo/Yr)* | Dates To *(Mo/Yr)* |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Calle 72 con Avenida 3H, Resic | Maracaibo | Zulia | Venezuela | 03/01/2014 | 02/27/2026 |
| N/A | N/A | N/A | N/A | N/A | N/A |

**2.** Provide the following information about your residences during the past 5 years. List your present address first.
*(***NOTE:** *Use Form I-589 Supplement B, or additional sheets of paper, if necessary.)*

| Number and Street | City/Town | Department, Province, or State | Country | Dates From *(Mo/Yr)* | Dates To *(Mo/Yr)* |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 4210 Bellaire Boulevard, Apt 12 | Houston | Texas | United States | 04/2026 | Present |
| Calle 72 con Avenida 3H, Resic | Maracaibo | Zulia | Venezuela | 01/2025 | 06/2025 |
| Avenida 15 Delicias, Edificio La | Maracaibo | Zulia | Venezuela | 03/2024 | 01/2025 |
| Calle 5 de Julio, Casa 23-41 | Cabimas | Zulia | Venezuela | 06/2025 | 02/2026 |
| Sector La Limpia, Calle 79F, Ca | Maracaibo | Zulia | Venezuela | 09/2023 | 03/2024 |

**3.** Provide the following information about your education, beginning with the most recent school that you attended.
*(***NOTE:** *Use Form I-589 Supplement B, or additional sheets of paper, if necessary.)*

| Name of School | Type of School | Location *(Address)* | Attended From *(Mo/Yr)* | Attended To *(Mo/Yr)* |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Universidad del Zulia, Facultad de Med | University | Avenida Universidad, Maracaibo, Z | 09/15/2009 | 07/20/2014 |
| Liceo Bolivariano Udon Perez | High School | Avenida 15 Delicias, Maracaibo, Z | 09/10/2003 | 07/15/2009 |
| N/A | N/A | N/A | N/A | N/A |
| N/A | N/A | N/A | N/A | N/A |

**4.** Provide the following information about your employment during the past 5 years. List your present employment first.
*(***NOTE:** *Use Form I-589 Supplement B, or additional sheets of paper, if necessary.)*

| Name and Address of Employer | Your Occupation | Dates From *(Mo/Yr)* | Dates To *(Mo/Yr)* |
|---|---|---|---|
| Hospital Universitario de Maracaibo, Avenida 20 con Calle 65, Mara | Intensive care nurse | 09/2014 | 02/2026 |
| N/A | N/A | N/A | N/A |
| N/A | N/A | N/A | N/A |

**5.** Provide the following information about your parents and siblings (brothers and sisters). Check the box if the person is deceased.
(**NOTE**: *Use Form I-589 Supplement B, or additional sheets of paper, if necessary.)*

| Full Name | City/Town and Country of Birth | Current Location |
|---|---|---|
| *Mother* Carmen Montero de Rivas | Cabimas, Venezuela | ☐ Deceased Maracaibo, Venezuela |
| *Father* Jose Gregorio Rivas Perdomo | Maracaibo, Venezuela | ☐ Deceased Maracaibo, Venezuela |
| *Sibling* Luis Gregorio Rivas Montero | Maracaibo, Venezuela | ☐ Deceased Unknown whereabouts since ( |
| *Sibling* Daniela Rivas Montero | Maracaibo, Venezuela | ☐ Deceased Bogota, Colombia |
| *Sibling* Andres Rivas Montero | Maracaibo, Venezuela | ☑ Deceased N/A |
| *Sibling* Gabriela Rivas Montero | Maracaibo, Venezuela | ☐ Deceased Lima, Peru |

## Part B. Information About Your Application

*(**NOTE:** Use Form I-589 Supplement B, or attach additional sheets of paper as needed to complete your responses to the questions contained in Part B.)*

When answering the following questions about your asylum or other protection claim (withholding of removal under 241(b)(3) of the INA or withholding of removal under the Convention Against Torture), you must provide a detailed and specific account of the basis of your claim to asylum or other protection. To the best of your ability, provide specific dates, places, and descriptions about each event or action described. You must attach documents evidencing the general conditions in the country from which you are seeking asylum or other protection and the specific facts on which you are relying to support your claim. If this documentation is unavailable or you are not providing this documentation with your application, explain why in your responses to the following questions.

USCIS may adjudicate your application without conducting an interview and without issuing a request for evidence. Your application and any supporting evidence that you provide now may be your only opportunity to meet your burden of proof to establish eligibility for asylum before USCIS.

Refer to Instructions, Part 1: Filing Instructions, Section II, "Basis of Eligibility," Parts A - D, Section V, "Completing the Form," Part B, and Section VII, "Additional Evidence That You Should Submit," for more information on completing this section of the form.

**1.** Why are you applying for asylum or withholding of removal under section 241(b)(3) of the INA, or for withholding of removal under the Convention Against Torture? Check the appropriate box(es) below and then provide detailed answers to questions A and B below.

I am seeking asylum or withholding of removal based on:

- ☐ Race
- ☐ Religion
- ☐ Nationality
- ☑ Political opinion
- ☑ Membership in a particular social group
- ☑ Torture Convention

**A.** Have you, your family, or close friends or colleagues ever experienced harm or mistreatment or threats in the past by anyone?

☐ No ☑ Yes

If "Yes," explain in detail:
**1.** What happened;
**2.** When the harm or mistreatment or threats occurred;
**3.** Who caused the harm or mistreatment or threats; and
**4.** Why you believe the harm or mistreatment or threats occurred.

I am an intensive care nurse. I worked for twelve years at the University Hospital of Maracaibo.

In February 2019, the hospital ran out of basic supplies. There were no gauzes, no antibiotics, and not enough oxygen. I saw three patients die in a week from preventable causes. Together with fourteen other nurses, we organized a protest in front of the hospital entrance. We carried signs with the list of missing items. I was one of those who spoke to the press.

On March 11, 2019, four plainclothes men detained me as I left the night shift. They did not show a warrant. They took me to a SEBIN facility on Avenida 15. I was held for four days in a windowless room. They interrogated me many times about who financed the protests and who gave me instructions. [Continued on Addendum.]

**B.** Do you fear harm or mistreatment if you return to your home country?

☐ No ☑ Yes

If "Yes," explain in detail:
**1.** What harm or mistreatment you fear;
**2.** Who you believe would harm or mistreat you; and
**3.** Why you believe you would or could be harmed or mistreated.

I fear that if I return, they will detain me at the airport and this time not release me.

The two detentions I suffered are in a SEBIN file that was never closed. The last time they expressly told me it was the last warning. My brother participated in the same meetings as I did, and we haven't known where he is for three years.

It's not just about me. They told me they would go after my children at school, and they gave me the name of the school so I would know they had it. Santiago was eight years old.

I also don't believe that moving to another part of Venezuela would protect me. [Continued on Addendum.]

## Part B. Information About Your Application (continued)

**2.** Have you or your family members ever been accused, charged, arrested, detained, interrogated, convicted and sentenced, or imprisoned in any country other than the United States (including for an immigration law violation)?

☐ No ☑ Yes

If "Yes," explain the circumstances and reasons for the action.

I was detained twice, both times without a judicial warrant, without formal charges, and without any document upon release.

The first was from March 11 to 15, 2019, by SEBIN agents in Maracaibo, after organizing the protest over the lack of supplies at the University Hospital. They interrogated me about who financed the protests. There was never a written accusation.

The second was from January 9 to 20, 2023, in the Cabimas Detention Center, after leaving a health workers' committee meeting. There were no charges or papers either. [Continued on Addendum.]

**3.A.** Have you or your family members ever belonged to or been associated with any organizations or groups in your home country, such as, but not limited to, a political party, student group, labor union, religious organization, military or paramilitary group, civil patrol, guerrilla organization, ethnic group, human rights group, or the press or media?

☐ No ☑ Yes

If "Yes," describe for each person the level of participation, any leadership or other positions held, and the length of time you or your family members were involved in each organization or activity.

Between 2021 and 2026, I belonged to the Health Workers' Committee of the University Hospital of Maracaibo. It was an informal committee, without legal registration, of about thirty people, including nurses, orderlies, and two doctors.

We met to document what supplies were missing and to complain to the hospital director and the Ministry. I kept the record of what was missing each week. I stopped participating when I left Venezuela in February 2026.

**3.B.** Do you or your family members continue to participate in any way in these organizations or groups?

☑ No ☐ Yes

If "Yes," describe for each person your or your family members' current level of participation, any leadership or other positions currently held, and the length of time you or your family members have been involved in each organization or group.

N/A

**4.** Are you afraid of being subjected to torture in your home country or any other country to which you may be returned?

☐ No ☑ Yes

If "Yes," explain why you are afraid and describe the nature of torture you fear, by whom, and why it would be inflicted.

I fear being tortured if I return because it has already happened to me twice.

In 2019, they beat me on the ribs and the soles of my feet during interrogations. In 2023, they took me out of the cell at night to interrogate me, deprived me of drinking water, and threatened me with my children.

Both times it was State agents, in State facilities, and both times I was detained without charges and without access to a lawyer. Those who did it remain in their positions, and the file was never closed.

## Part C. Additional Information About Your Application

You should ensure that your explanations are complete and detailed. An asylum officer may adjudicate your application without conducting an interview or requesting additional evidence.

(**NOTE:** *Use Form I-589 Supplement B, or attach additional sheets of paper as needed to complete your responses to the questions contained in Part C.*)

**1.** Have you, your spouse, your child(ren), your parents or your siblings ever applied to the U.S. Government for refugee status, asylum, or withholding of removal?

☑ No ☐ Yes

If "Yes," explain the decision and what happened to any status you, your spouse, your child(ren), your parents, or your siblings received as a result of that decision. Indicate whether or not you were included in a parent or spouse's application. If so, include your parent or spouse's A-number in your response. If you have been denied asylum by an immigration judge or the Board of Immigration Appeals, describe any change(s) in conditions in your country or your own personal circumstances since the date of the denial that may affect your eligibility for asylum.

N/A

**2.A.** After leaving the country from which you are claiming asylum, did you or your spouse or child(ren) who are now in the United States travel through or reside in any other country before entering the United States?

☐ No ☑ Yes

**2.B.** Have you, your spouse, your child(ren), or other family members, such as your parents or siblings, ever applied for or received any lawful status in any country other than the one from which you are now claiming asylum?

☑ No ☐ Yes

If "Yes" to either or both questions (2A and/or 2B), provide for each person the following: the name of each country and the length of stay, the person's status while there, the reasons for leaving, whether or not the person is entitled to return for lawful residence purposes, and whether the person applied for refugee status or for asylum while there, and if not, why he or she did not do so.

I flew before through Nicaragua but only with destination to USA

**3.** Have you, your spouse or your child(ren) ever ordered, incited, assisted or otherwise participated in causing harm or suffering to any person because of his or her race, religion, nationality, membership in a particular social group or belief in a particular political opinion?

☑ No ☐ Yes

If "Yes," describe in detail each such incident and your own, your spouse's, or your child(ren)'s involvement.

N/A

## Part C. Additional Information About Your Application (continued)

**4.** After you left the country where you were harmed or fear harm, did you return to that country?

☑ No ☐ Yes

If "Yes," describe in detail the circumstances of your visit(s) (for example, the date(s) of the trip(s), the purpose(s) of the trip(s), and the length of time you remained in that country for the visit(s).)

N/A

**5.** Are you filing this application more than 1 year after your last arrival in the United States?

☑ No ☐ Yes

If "Yes," explain why you did not file within the first year after you arrived. Your written explanation may be your only opportunity to have an asylum officer consider your reason(s). If you are scheduled for an asylum interview or a hearing with an immigration judge, you must be prepared to explain at your interview or hearing why you did not file your asylum application within the first year after you arrived. For guidance in answering this question, see Instructions, Part 1. Filing Instructions, Section V. Completing the Form, Part C.

N/A

**6.** Have you or any member of your family included in the application ever committed any crime and/or been arrested, charged, convicted, or sentenced for any crimes in the United States (including for an immigration law violation)?

☑ No ☐ Yes

If "Yes," for each instance, specify in your response: what occurred and the circumstances, dates, length of sentence received, location, the duration of the detention or imprisonment, reason(s) for the detention or conviction, any formal charges that were lodged against you or your relatives included in your application, and the reason(s) for release. Attach documents referring to these incidents, if they are available, or an explanation of why documents are not available.

N/A

## Part D. Your Signature

I certify, under penalty of perjury under the laws of the United States of America, that this application and the evidence submitted with it are all true and correct. Title 18, United States Code, Section 1546(a), provides in part: Whoever knowingly makes under oath, or as permitted under penalty of perjury under Section 1746 of Title 28, United States Code, knowingly subscribes as true, any false statement with respect to a material fact in any application, affidavit, or other document required by the immigration laws or regulations prescribed thereunder, or knowingly presents any such application, affidavit, or other document containing any such false statement or which fails to contain any reasonable basis in law or fact - shall be fined in accordance with this title or imprisoned for up to 25 years. I certify that I am physically present in the United States or seeking admission at a Port of Entry when I execute this application. I authorize the release of any information from my immigration record that U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services (USCIS) needs to determine eligibility for the benefit I am seeking.

***WARNING:*** **Applicants who are in the United States unlawfully are subject to removal if their asylum or withholding claims are not granted by an asylum officer or an immigration judge. Any information provided in completing this application may be used as a basis for the institution of, or as evidence in, removal proceedings even if the application is later withdrawn, and even if USCIS does not conduct an interview on the application. Applicants determined to have knowingly made a frivolous application for asylum will be permanently ineligible for any benefits under the Immigration and Nationality Act. You may not avoid a frivolous finding simply because someone advised you to provide false information in your asylum application. If filing with USCIS, unexcused failure to appear for an appointment to provide biometrics (such as fingerprints) and your biographical information within the time allowed may result in an asylum officer dismissing your asylum application or referring it to an immigration judge. Failure without good cause to provide DHS with biometrics or other biographical information while in removal proceedings may result in your application being found abandoned by the immigration judge. See sections 208(d)(5)(A) and 208(d)(6) of the INA and 8 CFR sections 208.10, 1208.10, 208.20, 1003.47(d) and 1208.20.**

| Print your complete name. | Write your name in your native alphabet. |
|---|---|
| N/A | |

Did your spouse, parent, or child(ren) assist you in completing this application? ☑ No ☐ Yes *(If "Yes," list the name and relationship.)*

| N/A | N/A | N/A | N/A |
|---|---|---|---|
| *(Name)* | *(Relationship)* | *(Name)* | *(Relationship)* |

Did someone other than your spouse, parent, or child(ren) prepare this application? ☑ No ☐ Yes *(If "Yes,"complete Part E.)*

Asylum applicants may be represented by counsel. Have you been provided with a list of persons who may be available to assist you, at little or no cost, with your asylum claim? ☐ No ☐ Yes

Signature of Applicant *(The person in Part. A.I.)*

➡ [ _____ ] _____

Sign your name so it all appears within the brackets — Date (mm/dd/yyyy)

## Part E. Declaration of Person Preparing Form, if Other Than Applicant, Spouse, Parent, or Child

I declare that I have prepared this application at the request of the person named in Part D, that the responses provided are based on all information of which I have knowledge, or which was provided to me by the applicant, and that the completed application was read to the applicant in his or her native language or a language he or she understands for verification before he or she signed the application in my presence. I am aware that the knowing placement of false information on the Form I-589 may also subject me to civil penalties under 8 U.S.C. 1324c and/or criminal penalties under 18 U.S.C. 1546(a).

| Signature of Preparer | Print Complete Name of Preparer |
|---|---|
| | N/A |

| Daytime Telephone Number | Address of Preparer: Street Number and Name |
|---|---|
| ( N/A ) N/A | N/A |

| Apt. Number | City | State | Zip Code |
|---|---|---|---|
| N/A | N/A | N/A | N/A |

| **To be completed by an attorney or accredited representative** (if any). | ☐ **Select this box if Form G-28 is attached.** | **Attorney State Bar Number** (if applicable) | **Attorney or Accredited Representative USCIS Online Account Number** (if any) |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | N/A | N / A |

## Part F. To Be Completed at Asylum Interview, if Applicable

**NOTE:** You will be asked to complete this part if you appear for examination before an asylum officer of the Department of Homeland Security, U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services (USCIS).

I swear (affirm) that I know the contents of this application that I am signing, including the attached documents and supplements, that they are ☐ all true or ☐ not all true to the best of my knowledge and that correction(s) numbered ____ to ____ were made by me or at my request. Furthermore, I am aware that if I am determined to have knowingly made a frivolous application for asylum I will be permanently ineligible for any benefits under the Immigration and Nationality Act, and that I may not avoid a frivolous finding simply because someone advised me to provide false information in my asylum application.

Signed and sworn to before me by the above named applicant on:

Signature of Applicant

Date *(mm/dd/yyyy)*

Write Your Name in Your Native Alphabet

Signature of Asylum Officer

## Part G. To Be Completed at Removal Hearing, if Applicable

**NOTE:** *You will be asked to complete this Part when you appear before an immigration judge of the U.S. Department of Justice, Executive Office for Immigration Review (EOIR), for a hearing.*

I swear (affirm) that I know the contents of this application that I am signing, including the attached documents and supplements, that they are ☐ all true or ☐ not all true to the best of my knowledge and that correction(s) numbered ____ to ____ were made by me or at my request. Furthermore, I am aware that if I am determined to have knowingly made a frivolous application for asylum I will be permanently ineligible for any benefits under the Immigration and Nationality Act, and that I may not avoid a frivolous finding simply because someone advised me to provide false information in my asylum application.

Signed and sworn to before me by the above named applicant on:

Signature of Applicant

N/A

Date *(mm/dd/yyyy)*

Write Your Name in Your Native Alphabet

Signature of Immigration Judge

# Application for Asylum and for Withholding of Removal Supplement A

**Department of Homeland Security**
U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services

**USCIS**
**Form I-589**
OMB No. 1615-0069
Expires 09/30/2027

| A-Number *(If available)* | Date |
|---|---|
| N/A | N/A |
| **Applicant's Name** | **Applicant's Signature** |
| Maria Alejandra Rivas Montero | N/A |

## List All of Your Children, Regardless of Age or Marital Status

*(**NOTE:** Use this form and attach additional pages and documentation as needed, if you have more than four children)*

| **1.** Alien Registration Number (A-Number) *(if any)* | **2.** Passport/ID Card Number *(if any)* | **3.** Marital Status *(Married, Single, Divorced, Widowed)* | **4.** U.S. Social Security Number *(if any)* |
|---|---|---|---|
| N/A | 152884485 | Single | N/A |
| **5.** Complete Last Name | **6.** First Name | **7.** Middle Name | **8.** Date of Birth *(mm/dd/yyyy)* |
| Fernandez Rivas | Diego | N/A | 05/15/2015 |
| **9.** City and Country of Birth | **10.** Nationality *(Citizenship)* | **11.** Race, Ethnic, or Tribal Group | **12.** Sex |
| Maracaibo, Venezuela | Venezuelan | N/A | ☑ Male ☐ Female |

**13.** Is this child in the U.S. ? ☑ Yes *(Complete Blocks 14 to 21.)* ☐ No *(Specify location)*: Houston, Texas

| **14.** Place of last entry into the U.S. | **15.** Date of last entry into the U.S. *(mm/dd/yyyy)* | **16.** I-94 Number *(If any)* | **17.** Status when last admitted *(Visa type, if any)* |
|---|---|---|---|
| Eagle Pass, Texas | 03/15/2026 | N/A | Humanitarian parole |

| **18.** What is your child's current status? | **19.** What is the expiration date of his/her authorized stay, if any? *(mm/dd/yyyy)* | **20.** Is your child in Immigration Court proceedings? |
|---|---|---|
| Humanitarian parole | 03/15/2028 | ☐ Yes ☑ No |

**21.** If in the U.S., is this child to be included in this application? *(Check the appropriate box.)*

☑ Yes

☐ No

| **1.** Alien Registration Number (A-Number) *(if any)* | **2.** Passport/ID Card Number *(if any)* | **3.** Marital Status *(Married, Single, Divorced, Widowed)* | **4.** U.S. Social Security Number *(if any)* |
|---|---|---|---|
| N/A | 152884486 | Single | N/A |
| **5.** Complete Last Name | **6.** First Name | **7.** Middle Name | **8.** Date of Birth *(mm/dd/yyyy)* |
| Fernandez Rivas | Camila | N/A | 06/16/2016 |
| **9.** City and Country of Birth | **10.** Nationality *(Citizenship)* | **11.** Race, Ethnic, or Tribal Group | **12.** Sex |
| Maracaibo, Venezuela | Venezuelan | N/A | ☐ Male ☑ Female |

**13.** Is this child in the U.S. ? ☑ Yes *(Complete Blocks 14 to 21.)* ☐ No *(Specify location)*: Houston, Texas

| **14.** Place of last entry into the U.S. | **15.** Date of last entry into the U.S. *(mm/dd/yyyy)* | **16.** I-94 Number *(If any)* | **17.** Status when last admitted *(Visa type, if any)* |
|---|---|---|---|
| Eagle Pass, Texas | 03/15/2026 | N/A | Humanitarian parole |

| **18.** What is your child's current status? | **19.** What is the expiration date of his/her authorized stay, if any? *(mm/dd/yyyy)* | **20.** Is your child in Immigration Court proceedings? |
|---|---|---|
| Humanitarian parole | 03/15/2028 | ☐ Yes ☑ No |

**21.** If in the U.S., is this child to be included in this application? *(Check the appropriate box.)*

☑ Yes

☐ No

## Additional Information About Your Claim to Asylum

| A-Number *(if available)* | Date |
|---|---|
| N/A | 10/29/2026 |
| Applicant's Name | Applicant's Signature |
| Maria Alejandra Rivas Montero | |

**NOTE:** *Use this as a continuation page for any additional information requested. Copy and complete as needed.*

**Part** A.II

**Question** Your Children

Continuation of Part A.II, Your Children. Children 1 to 4 are on pages 2 and 3 of the form; children 5 and 6 are on Supplement A.

Child 7
Alien Registration Number (A-Number): N/A
Passport/ID Card Number: 152884487
Marital Status: Single
U.S. Social Security Number: N/A
Complete Last Name: Fernandez Rivas
First Name: Tomas
Middle Name: N/A
Date of Birth (mm/dd/yyyy): 07/17/2017
City and Country of Birth: Maracaibo, Venezuela
Nationality (Citizenship): Venezuelan
Race, Ethnic, or Tribal Group: N/A
Gender: Male
Is this child in the U.S.?: Yes
Location, if not in the U.S.: Houston, Texas
Place of last entry into the U.S.: Eagle Pass, Texas
Date of last entry into the U.S. (mm/dd/yyyy): 03/15/2026
I-94 Number: N/A
Status when last admitted (Visa type, if any): Humanitarian parole
Current status: Humanitarian parole
Expiration date of authorized stay (mm/dd/yyyy): 03/15/2028
Is your child in Immigration Court proceedings?: No
If in the U.S., is this child to be included in this application?: Yes

Form I-589, Application for Asylum and for Withholding of Removal
Addendum - Page 1 of 5
Continuation to: Section 1 - Residences during the past 5 years
Applicant's Name: Maria Alejandra Rivas Montero
A-Number: N/A
Part: A.III Question: 2

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Residences 1 to 5 are on page 4 of the form.

Residence 6
Number and Street: Urbanizacion San Jacinto, Sector 4, Vereda 12
City/Town: Maracaibo
Department, Province, or State: Zulia
Country: Venezuela
From (Mo/Yr): 02/2022
To (Mo/Yr): 09/2023

Residence 7
Number and Street: Avenida Bella Vista, Residencias Paraiso, Apt 2C
City/Town: Maracaibo
Department, Province, or State: Zulia
Country: Venezuela
From (Mo/Yr): 10/2021
To (Mo/Yr): 02/2022

Applicant's Signature: _____ Date (mm/dd/yyyy): _____

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Mother, father and siblings 1 to 4 are on page 4 of the form.

Sibling 5
Full Name: Miguel Rivas Montero
City/Town and Country of Birth: Maracaibo, Venezuela
Deceased: No
Current Location: Maracaibo, Venezuela

Sibling 6
Full Name: Sofia Rivas Montero
City/Town and Country of Birth: Maracaibo, Venezuela
Deceased: No
Current Location: Santiago, Chile

Sibling 7
Full Name: Rafael Rivas Montero
City/Town and Country of Birth: Maracaibo, Venezuela
Deceased: No
Current Location: Madrid, Spain

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One told me: "you are not a nurse, you are a politician, and politicians here disappear." They beat me on the ribs and the soles of my feet. They did not let me call my husband. They released me without charges and without any paper.

I returned to work because I needed the salary. In 2021, I helped form a health workers' committee. They started following me. Twice I found my house lock tampered with.

On January 9, 2023, I was detained again, after leaving a committee meeting. This time it was eleven days in the Cabimas Detention Center. I shared a cell with nine women. There was no drinking water. They took me out at night to interrogate me. They told me that if I continued, they would go after my children at school. They released me on January 20 with the warning that it was the last time.

On September 14, 2023, my brother Luis Gregorio left his house and never returned. We reported the disappearance. No one investigated. He had participated in the same meetings as I did.

In January 2026, collectives painted the door of my building with the word "traitor" and my apartment number. That week we decided to leave.

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SEBIN is national, and my name appeared in the press when we spoke about the lack of supplies. In Venezuela, there is no one to ask for protection: those who detained me are the State.

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Both times I was released without explanation. I had no lawyer in either case, there was no trial, and there is no sentence. I understand there might be an open case, but I was never given anything to say so, and I have no way to verify it from here.

My brother Luis Gregorio Rivas Montero was briefly detained in 2022 for participating in a protest and has been missing since September 14, 2023.